Year/period	Drone/ system name	Developer/ country	Technological features	Purpose/ application	S c
		Co. (United Kingdom)	on the Tiger Moth trainer aircraft.	and target simulation.	p U t “
1939–1945	*Radioplane OQ-2*	Reginald Denny Industries (United States)	Catapult-launched, radio-controlled drone powered by a small piston engine.	Target drone for US Army Air Corps gunnery practice.	F b p e d p t

2.3.1 Early experiments and innovations

The roots of unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) development can be traced back to the pre-World War I era, when scientists and engineers first began experimenting with the idea of pilotless flight. During the late 19th and early 20th centuries, inventors explored ways to use emerging technologies, particularly radio communication and lightweight engines, to achieve remotely controlled flight. These early efforts were largely experimental and lacked the precision or reliability of later systems, but they established the fundamental concepts that would define UAV design for decades.

The concept of unmanned flight began to take form with the development of automatic and remotely guided aircraft. Innovators such as Nikola Tesla were among the first to envision remotely controlled vehicles. In 1898,